



Showstoppers: England's Anya Shrubsole (left) took six wickets in the 2017 final to deny India the title.

Below: Deandra Dottin runs out Fran Jones in the final over as West Indies won by three runs against New Zealand in the 2022 edition.

and Brits was left waging a lone battle. With contributions from Shandre Fritz (23) and Claire Terblanche (20), Brits' 72 did the heavy lifting as South Africa posted 169 before being bundled out in 49 overs. Defending 170, it was Brits who was the architect of the Windies' collapse. The all-rounder trapped

Juliana Nero lbw and sent her back for 41.

At this point, the chasing side was 108/5 in 31.4 overs. West Indies went on to lose five wickets for 60 runs, and Brits took 4/37 in 9.4 overs to cap off a historic one-run win for the Proteas.

Bristol 2017: Sri Lanka - 257/9; Australia - 262/2 | Aus won by eight wickets

Cricket may be a team sport, but once in a while an individual effort can outshine everything else. Chamari Athapaththu's unbeaten 178 from 143 balls against Australia during the 2017 World Cup is one

such example. Sent in to bat, Sri Lanka consistently lost wickets from one end, while from the other, Athapaththu produced an astonishing display of stroke-making replete with elegant drives, crunching pulls, and towering sixes. By the time she was done, she had amassed the second-highest score in a Women's ODI World Cup. As it so happened, while her innings was worthy of winning any game, it would come in a losing cause. Alyssa Healy responded with a stunning 152 not out of her own as the Australians cantered to an eight-wicket victory. However, the story of the match was less the result, and more the extraordinary effort of Sri Lanka's No. 3.

Derby 2017: India - 281/4; Australia - 245 | India won by 36 runs

It was a chance for the Indians to reach only its second World Cup final. For the Australians, it was just another semifinal, another box to tick in another one of its title defences.

The last-four fixture began with the Mithali Raj-led side deciding to bat at the County Ground in Derby and straightaway, southpaw Smriti Mandhana was sent back at the end of the first over. The Australians saw the back of Punam Raut soon enough, but Mithali and her soon-to-be successor Harmanpreet Kaur added 66 runs for the third wicket to steady things. While Mithali too soon departed, the Australians suffered the wrath of Harmanpreet, who stayed put till the end and smashed a monumental 171* off 115 balls — a knock embellished with 20 fours and seven sixes. The Punjab big-hitter also stitched a 137-run partnership with Deepti Sharma to help India score 281.

The Indian bowlers, led by the pace battery of Jhulan Goswami and Shikha Pandey, cleaned up the Australian top-three for just 21 runs. The partnership of Ellyse Perry (38) and Elyse Villani (75) brought the chase back on track. When Rajeshwari Gayakwad sent Villani back, India might have felt the momentum swing back in its favour, but Alex Blackwell proved to be another thorn in its road to the final.

